



Bolo Saathi

Installation and Setup Manual

फ़ोन जो आपकी भाषा समझे

Version 1.0 · October 2026

Team Orynex · AI Build Challenge 2026, Track 06

Contents

1. What you need
2. Download the app
3. Install the APK (and the Play Protect message)
4. First launch and login
5. Turn on permissions
6. Set up family safety
7. Add your people and contacts
8. Make the voice work well
9. Things to try
10. Troubleshooting
11. For developers: build from source
12. Privacy and safety

About Bolo Saathi

Bolo Saathi is an Android helper for people who find English apps hard to use. You press one big mic and speak in Hindi, Bhojpuri or Maithili. It sends money and messages, reads bills and screens aloud, finds government schemes, checks scams, reminds you of medicines, keeps an expense diary and keeps your family close with SOS.

1. What you need

Item	Details
Phone	Android 8.0 or newer. A real phone is needed (mic and accessibility do not work well on emulators).
Internet	Mobile data or WiFi. Needed for understanding speech, answers and photo reading. The UPI scam warning works offline.
Google apps	The phone's Google speech service and Google text to speech (already present on most phones).
Space	About 40 MB free.
UPI app (optional)	PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm or BHIM for voice payments.

2. Download the app

- 1 On your phone, open this link in Chrome:
`github.com/devadnan90/BoloSaathi-AI-Android/releases`
- 2 Under the latest release, open **Assets** and tap the **.apk** file to download it.
- 3 If Chrome warns that the file may be harmful, tap **Download anyway**.

3. Install the APK

- 1 Open the downloaded file from the notification or from **Files > Downloads**.
- 2 If Android asks, allow installs from this source: tap **Settings**, turn on **Allow from this source**, then go back.
- 3 Tap **Install**, then **Open**.

If you see "App blocked to protect your device"

Google Play Protect blocks apps from outside the Play Store that use Accessibility, SMS and notification access. Bolo Saathi needs these for its safety features, so this message is expected. To install:

1. Open **Play Store > your profile photo > Play Protect > Settings (gear icon)**.
2. Turn off **Scan apps with Play Protect**.
3. Install the APK again.
4. Go back and turn **Scan apps with Play Protect** on again.

Developers can also install with Android Studio or `adb install`, which is not blocked.

"App not installed" error?

An older Bolo Saathi with a different signature is already on the phone. Uninstall it first, then install the new APK.

4. First launch and login

- 1 Open Bolo Saathi and tap शुरू करें.
- 2 Type your name, or tap the small mic in the name box and say it.
- 3 Enter your 10 digit mobile number.
- 4 Choose your language: हिंदी, भोजपुरी or मैथिली. Tap **चलिए शुरू करें**.

Your name and number stay only on your phone. You can change the language later from Settings.

5. Turn on permissions

a) Phone control (Accessibility), the most important one

This lets Bolo Saathi tap and type in other apps when you ask, read the screen aloud and warn you about UPI scams.

- 1 On the home screen, tap the pill फ़ोन चलाने की अनुमति दें.
- 2 In Accessibility settings, open **Installed apps** or **Downloaded apps**, choose **Bolo Saathi** and turn it on.

Switch is grey or says "Restricted setting"? (Android 13 and newer)

Open **Settings > Apps > Bolo Saathi**, tap the **three dots** in the top right corner, choose **Allow restricted settings**, then turn on Accessibility again.

b) Other permissions

Permission	Where to give it	Used for
Microphone	First tap on the mic	Hearing you, only while the mic is on
Contacts	मेरे लोग > फ़ोन के कॉन्टैक्ट भी जोड़ें	Finding people by name for calls, WhatsApp and recharge
SMS, Phone, Location	First tap on SOS, or when you enter the family number	SOS message with location, calls, family payment alert
Camera	First use of पढ़ के सुनाओ	Reading bills, letters and medicine strips
Notifications	Opening दवा और खर्च	Medicine reminders and the morning update
Notification access	Settings toggle मैसेज पढ़कर सुनाओ	Reading new WhatsApp and SMS aloud

6. Set up family safety

Open **सेटिंग** and find the card **सुविधाएँ**.

Setting	What it does
परिवार का नंबर	The 10 digit number that gets the SOS message and big payment alerts. If empty, Bolo Saathi uses someone from मेरे लोग (for example मम्मी or बेटा).
सुबह का हाल	Every day at 8 AM it speaks the weather, today's medicines and yesterday's spend.
मैसेज पढ़कर सुनाओ	Reads new WhatsApp and SMS aloud. OTP messages are never read.
कॉल के बाद चेतावनी	After a call from an unknown number, warns you about OTP and KYC scams.
बड़े पेमेंट पर परिवार को खबर	Sends an SMS to the family when a payment of ₹2000 or more is being made.
तैरता माइक बटन	A small mic that floats over every app. Tap it and speak anywhere.
धोखा चेतावनी	Warns you out loud inside UPI apps when the screen looks like a money request trap.

7. Add your people

- 1 Open **मेरे लोग** and tap **+ जोड़ें**.
- 2 Write the name the way you say it (मम्मी, बबुआ, रमेश भैया), the mobile number and, for payments, the UPI ID.
- 3 Tap **फ़ोन के कॉन्टैक्ट भी जोड़ें** so you can also use any phone contact by name. Contacts saved in English (like "Lokesh") are found even when you say the name in Hindi.

8. Make the voice work well

- **Hindi voice for replies:** **Settings > System > Languages > Text to speech output**, choose Google and download **Hindi (India)**.
- **Hindi speech input:** make sure the Google app is installed and updated. Offline Hindi can be added in Google voice typing settings.
- Tap the mic, wait until the rings start moving and you see **बोलिए, मैं सुन रहा हूँ**, then speak clearly.
- **Keep it running:** in **Settings > Apps > Bolo Saathi > Battery**, choose **Unrestricted**. On Xiaomi, Vivo, Oppo and Realme phones also turn on **Autostart**.

9. Things to try

Say this	What happens
मम्मी को 500 रुपये भेज दो	Asks "भेज दूँ?", then opens your UPI app and fills the details. You enter the PIN yourself.
बेटा को व्हाट्सएप पर लिखो मैं घर पहुँच गया	Confirms, opens WhatsApp and sends the message.
रमेश को कॉल करो	Finds Ramesh in contacts, confirms and places the call.
फ़ोनपे में लोकेश का 299 वाला रिचार्ज कर दो	Opens PhonePe Mobile Recharge with Lokesh's number and stops at the PIN screen.
ये क्या लिखा है?	From the floating mic in any app: reads the screen aloud in your language.
पढ़ के सुनाओ (camera)	Take a photo of a bill or letter and hear what it says.
मुझे कौन सी सरकारी योजना मिलेगी?	Asks simple questions and suggests schemes, documents and where to apply.
ये लॉटरी वाला मैसेज सच है?	Tells you if it looks like a scam and what to do.
रोज़ सुबह 8 बजे BP की दवा याद दिलाना	Sets a daily spoken reminder.
आज 200 की सब्ज़ी ली	Adds to the expense diary. Ask "इस महीने कितना खर्च हुआ?" any time.
आज का हाल सुनाओ	Weather, today's medicines and yesterday's spend.
बचाओ or the red SOS button	Sends your location to the family by SMS and calls them.

Home screen widget

Long press an empty spot on your home screen, open **Widgets**, find **Bolo Saathi** and place it. Tap the widget to start speaking straight away.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"App blocked to protect your device"	Turn off Play Protect scanning for a moment, install, turn it back on (see section 3).
"App not installed"	Uninstall the old Bolo Saathi first, then install again.
Accessibility switch is grey	App info > three dots > Allow restricted settings (see section 5).
"सुनाई नहीं दिया" every time	Check mic permission, update the Google app, wait for the rings before speaking, and move to a quieter place.
"इंटरनेट में दिक्कत है"	Check mobile data or WiFi. On some WiFi networks, set Private DNS to <code>dns.google</code> in network settings. Developers: check the Gemini key.
Contact not found	Give contacts permission in मेरे लोग, or add the person there with a number.
SOS says add a family number	Enter परिवार का नंबर in Settings, or add someone with a number in मेरे लोग.
SOS SMS not sent	Allow SMS and Phone permissions. On dual SIM phones, set a default SIM for SMS in phone settings.
UPI payment fails or is blocked	Some UPI apps block payments started by other apps. Turn on Accessibility so Bolo Saathi fills the details inside your UPI app, or use the copied UPI ID and pay manually.
Reminders or warnings stop	Set battery to Unrestricted and turn on Autostart (section 8).
Recharge goes to a wrong screen	Press back and try again. Phone control is AI based and app layouts differ between phones.

11. For developers: build from source

1. Install Android Studio (Ladybug or newer) with JDK 17.
2. Clone the repository:

```
git clone https://github.com/devadnan90/BoloSaathi-AI-Android.git
```

3. Get a free Gemini API key from aistudio.google.com/apikey.
4. Create or open `local.properties` in the project root and add:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=your_key_here
```

This file is ignored by git, so the key never goes to GitHub. The key can also be pasted inside the app under Settings.

5. Open the project in Android Studio, connect a phone with USB debugging on, and press **Run**.
6. To build an APK to share:

```
./gradlew assembleDebug  
# output: app/build/outputs/apk/debug/app-debug.apk
```

Tech stack: Kotlin, Jetpack Compose, Material 3, Accessibility Service, Gemini API (with automatic fallback between Flash models), OkHttp, AlarmManager, NotificationListenerService, Open-Meteo for weather.

12. Privacy and safety

- Bolo Saathi always asks before sending money, sending a message or submitting a form.
- It never reads, types or stores a PIN, OTP, CVV or password. You enter the UPI PIN yourself.
- Your name, number, people, reminders and diary stay on your phone. There is no Bolo Saathi server.
- Spoken text, and photos you choose to read, are sent to Google Gemini only to understand and answer.
- Every extra feature can be switched off in Settings.

Cyber fraud happened?

Call **1930** right away or report at cybercrime.gov.in.

Full Privacy Policy and Terms are inside the app under सेटिंग > जानकारी.
Team Orynex · Md Adnan Hassan, IIIT Manipur · github.com/devadnan90
Made with love in Bihar.